Aral3D

A public 3D platform for learning, memory, and environmental imagination.

What it is

Aral3D is a browser-based 3D platform about the Aral Sea region.

It combines maps, terrain, stories, environmental data, and interactive scenarios into one public learning tool — for schools, museums, festivals, and cultural institutions.

0 3 — C O N T E X T

Why the Aral Sea

The Aral Sea is one of the most important environmental stories of the region.

It is not only about a vanishing sea — it is about water, health, infrastructure, agriculture, memory, climate, borders, and future choices. Aral3D helps people see these layers together.

Flat maps, distant stories

Most people meet the Aral Sea through flat maps, old photographs, statistics, or disaster narratives — important, but distant.

Aral3D makes the region spatial, interactive, and easier to understand. Instead of only reading about change, users can move through it, test scenarios, and ask questions.

Maps are not neutral

The way we imagine water affects the way we treat it.

Water can appear as a resource, a border, a memory, a health issue, an infrastructure system, a political question, or a shared future. Aral3D turns the map into a space for learning, questioning, and imagination.

What it does

Explore the basin in 3D — terrain, water, settlements, canals, dams.

- See environmental data layered on real geography.
- Test future water scenarios and policy choices.
- Move between modes: explore, learn, play, build.

The prototype works

A working public version is live today.

3D terrain across the Aral Sea basin.

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- Map layers: water history, population, ecology, infrastructure.
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- Interactive water scenarios.
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- A game mode and a voxel survival mode for younger audiences.
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Where it lands first

Aral Culture Summit 2026

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- Savitsky Museum
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- History and Aral Sea Museum
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- Center for Contemporary Art, Tashkent
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- Schools and educational programs
-
- Public workshops and festivals
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A tool for classrooms

Geography	How water systems work and how landscapes change.
Ecology	How human decisions shape fragile ecosystems.
History	Memory of a region told through its terrain.
Design	Visual literacy for maps, data, and storytelling.
Civics	Shared decisions about water, land, and future.

Installation, archive, speculation

Aral3D can also live as a cultural object — an installation, an archive, a speculative tool.

Tashkent Design Week
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- Milan Design Week
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- Venice Architecture Biennale
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- Venice Art Biennale
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Free, by default

Aral3D is free for schools, museums, researchers, and the public.

Core support

Ministries, museums, schools, cultural foundations, environmental organisations, and international institutions.

Optional

Paid adaptations for private museums, festivals, educational centres, and commissioned exhibitions.

From prototype to platform

$30,000

for the first 6 months

Polish, learning materials, audience testing, museum & festival formats.

$50,000

per year, 3-year phase

Maintain the platform, expand content, support workshops, keep it free.

Six months, one public version

Polish	Product and user experience.
Demo	A presentable public version.
Materials	Educational content for classrooms.
Testing	With students, teachers, museum audiences.
Formats	Festival and exhibition adaptations.
Partners	Institutional partnerships and documentation.

A living public platform

Over three years Aral3D can grow into a long-term public platform for the Aral Sea region.

New layers, new stories, new educational modules and installations — a learning tool and a cultural archive that stays alive, updates over time, and remains accessible.

Aral is the first case

Caspian Sea

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- Venice
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- River deltas
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- Drylands
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- Irrigation landscapes
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- Other climate-affected regions
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The prototype is already alive

Environmental education needs better tools. Museums and schools need formats that are visual, interactive, and accessible.

The Aral Sea story needs to be told not only as a past disaster, but as a living question about the future. With support, Aral3D moves from prototype to public platform.

Team

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